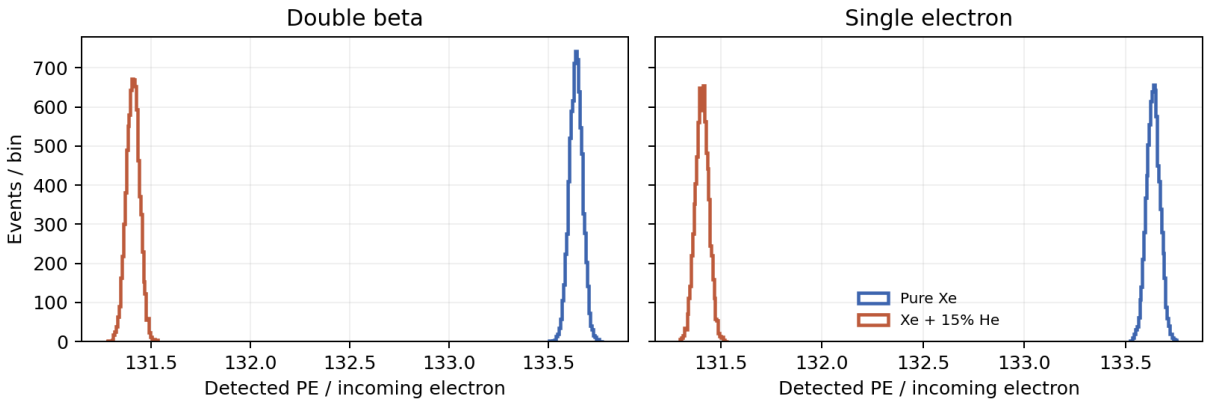
Ion pad and electron SiPM readout

NAUSICAA analysis

29 October 2026

Six Julia processes collected 8,000 events from each MC sample in 186.84 s. Each retained ion cloud was mapped to pads; pure-Xe and Xe–15% He electron clouds were assigned to EL holes and reduced to detected photoelectrons (PE) per SiPM and time bucket. Every input carrier was assigned to a grid cell.

Sample	Readout	Input/event	Signal/event	Signal/input	Buckets/event
bb0nu	ions	112,143	112,143	1.00	1,466
bb0nu	pure Xe e^-	112,106	14,981,352	133.64	958
bb0nu	Xe–He e^-	112,129	14,734,431	131.41	378
electrons	ions	112,143	112,143	1.00	1,690
electrons	pure Xe e^-	112,114	14,982,529	133.64	1,152
electrons	Xe–He e^-	112,132	14,734,764	131.41	458



Grid and timing inputs. Ion pads have 2 mm pitch and 20 ms buckets at 0.1 m/s drift speed. Electron holes have 10 mm pitch and 5 mm diameter, with 5 mm EL depth. PE are assigned to 2 microsecond buckets at the configured conversion of 1 mm/microsecond. The ion and electron arrival orders are opposite. An independent uniform phase is used for each physical grid; the electron phase is shared by the two gas models of an event. The EL reduced field is 3 kV/cm/bar at 15 bar, with gate/anode potentials 0/22500 V in a relative voltage gauge.

Optical model. The fitted mean EL yields from the Xe–He study are 2332.4 and 2293.5 photons per electron for pure Xe and Xe–15% He. Photons are isotropic along the hole axis; VUV rays touching the walls are absorbed. The analytic direct-light acceptance is 0.190983 and the configured SiPM PDE is 30%. The fitted yield is held at its mean; PE counts are sampled with an exact binomial draw from the combined optical acceptance and PDE. PE are placed in the parent electron's arrival bucket; in-hole transit delay and electronics noise are outside this readout stage. The Xe–He EL fits were measured near 1.2 bar; their use at 15 bar applies reduced-field scaling.

Validation. The ion signal equals the retained input ion count in every event. Saved grid indices and time buckets account for each signal; pure-Xe and Xe–He readouts share a transverse grid phase per event. The complete event-wise validation results accompany the HDF5 run summary.